8.4 Roles and Privileges

Back

The parts of Beacon described below are generally only available to the **Site Administrator**.

This video gives background and context to the topic.

Roles and Privileges 2021-12-12

Definitions

Roles are the means by which access **Privileges** are assigned to users. Privileges determine which parts of Beacon a user may access and the tasks they may carry out according to their role requirements.

Privileges are allocated to Roles (not people). Roles should be considered as being equivalent to 'jobs', whereas users are people. When the person carrying out a particular job changes, the Roles allocated to their User Record will need to be updated and another user may need to be assigned to the Role. The Role itself, and the Privileges attached to the Role, should not normally need to be changed.

To display a list of Roles, click **Roles and privileges** from the Home Page.

When a u3a adopts the Beacon System, the following default Roles are already set up:

Administration

Group Leader

Groups Coordinator

Membership Secretary

Treasurer

User Roles

Role Name	Committee role
Administration	
Group Leaders	
Groups Coordinator	
Membership Secretary	Y
Treasurer	Y

Click on a Role Name to view the **Role Record** and associated Privileges.

Role Record

Name: Membership Secretary

Committee role: ☑

Notes:

Record last changed 28 Feb 2019 16:47

Save Role | Delete Role

Privileges

Assign privileges by ticking the appropriate checkboxes below and then pressing Save Privileges.
For security, always assign the minimum privileges necessary

	View	Create	Change	Delete	Other
Address labels	☑				☑ Download
Addresses export	☑				☑ Download
Audit detail	☐				
Audit trail	☐			☐	
Calendar	☐				☐ Download
Data export + backup	☐				☐ Download
E-mail	☑				☑ Send

When editing a Role, click all the boxes that the Role requires and press the **Save Role** button to commit the changes. If a Role is no longer required, you can press the **Delete Role** button to remove the Role from the system.

Adding a new Role

Click **Add Role** from the list of roles or an existing Role Record. Give the Role a name and tick the box if it is a committee Role, before pressing the **Save Role** button.

Assigning Privileges to a Role

Under the **Privileges** heading, assign the Privileges required for the Role.

For good security, always assign the minimum privileges necessary to carry out the required administration/functions of the role (avoiding the 'nice to have' options).

Clicking on a row or column header will toggle all privileges in that row/column.

To remove privileges, simply untick the corresponding checkboxes.

Privileges refer to distinct parts of Beacon and are subdivided, as applicable, with separate access rights for **viewing** records, **creating** new records, **changing** existing records and **deleting.** Note that the privilege to view will be required for anyone who needs to create, change or delete a record.

Separate privileges are assigned to operations such as downloading documents, sending emails, etc. Users will not be able to send emails if their roles are not assigned the **Email: Send**

Group operations sometimes apply separately to '**all**', '**as leader**' and '**as member'**. Roles that are assigned 'all' privileges can access the records for all groups. Those assigned 'as leader' can only access the groups of which the user is a leader. Those assigned 'as member' can only access the groups of which the user is an individual member.

Operations such as '**Member classes**' refer to setting up membership classes, not the selection of classes in Member Records, for example. Operation names often correspond to similar names on the Home Page.

Press the **Save Privileges** button to commit the allocation of Privileges to a Role.

Note that roles are additive in that you can assign more than one role to a User and they will have the combined Privileges of the Roles. This can be useful if you want a role that extends an exiting role with an extra Privilege. For example, to give a Group Leader the ability to see the whole membership list define a role **Group Leader Plus** with just **Members list** ticked. Then assign both **Group Leader** and **Group Leader Plus** Roles to the Group Leader concerned.

Privileges Available

Refer to the Privileges Map and default Privileges to see how the tick boxes on the Role Record page (below) relate to operations within Beacon. The default privileges lists the default Roles when a new Beacon site is created.

These are the recommended default Privileges for with these Roles - However a lot is dependent on who does what duties in your u3a.

	View	Create	Change	Delete	Other
Address labels	☐				☐ Download
Addresses export	☐				☐ Download
Audit detail	☐				
Audit trail	☐			☐	
Calendar	☐				☐ Download
Data export + backup	☐				☐ Download
E-mail	☐				☐ Send
E-mail addresses					☐ Download
E-mail delivery	☐				☐ All
E-mail standard messages	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Finance: accounts	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Finance: batches	☐	☐		☐	
Finance: categories	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Finance: ledger	☐				☐ Download
Finance: reconcile accounts	☐				☐ Reconcile
Finance: statement	☐				☐ Download
Finance: transactions	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Finance: transfer money	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Gift Aid declaration	☐				☐ Download & Mark

	View	Create	Change	Delete	Other
Group faculties	☑	☐	☐	☐	
Group leaders	☑				☑ E-mail/Labels
Group ledger (all)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐ Download
Group ledger (as leader)	☑	☑	☑	☑	☐ Download
Group records (all)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐ Download members
Group records (as leader)	☑		☑	☑	☑ Download members
Group records (as member)	☐		☐		
Group statement	☐				☐ Download
Group venues	☑	☐	☐	☐	
Groups list	☑				☐ Download
Groups: add members by name			☐		
Groups: add members by name (as leader)			☑		
Groups: add members by no			☐		
Groups: add members by no (as leader)			☑		
Letters	☐				☐ Download
Letters: standard messages	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Meetings	☑	☑	☐	☐	
Member classes	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Member record	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Member statuses	☐	☐	☐	☐	

	View	Create	Change	Delete	Other
Members list	☐				☐ Download
Members: delete expired	☐			☐	
Members: non-renewals	☐				☐ Lapse
Members: recent	☐				☐ Download
Membership cards	☐				☐ Download & Mark
Membership renewals	☐				☐ Renew
Membership statistics	☐				☐ Download
Offices	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Poll set up	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Public links	☐				
Role record	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Roles list	☐				
Settings	☐		☐		
System messages	☐	☐	☐		
User record	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Users list	☐				
	View	Create	Change	Delete	Other

Save Privileges

Please note the new facility so a Group Leader can be given the ability to download the Group List.

Recommendation

When setting up the Roles and Privileges for the first time, it can help you understanding of Roles and Privileges if you do the following:

1. Create an ‘ordinary’ System User for yourself (if you don’t have one already).

2. Allocate one or more Roles to your ordinary user account.

3. Log out of Beacon and log back in using your ordinary user account so that you can explore the functionality available with the Role to see if it meets your requirements. This way you can easily identify if you have missed something or need to change anything before allocating it to the real role holder.

4. After you have finished testing, log back in as Admin and re-allocate the real Roles to your ordinary user account.

Revision History

v1	2020-04-04	Graeme Bunting	Original version
v2	2020-05-18	Graeme Bunting	Reference to Beacon User Guide removed. Links to Privileges Map and Default Privileges Map added.
v3	2021-11-20	Graham Tigg	Pointed out assigning multiple roles are cumulative with an example.
v4	2021-12-14	David Powers	Video added
v5	2024-07-02	Graeme Bunting	Email notify when New Member joins online added
v6	2024-12-15	Graeme Bunting	Email notify when New Member joins online removed
v7	2025-08-24	John Alexander	Add option to allow or not Group Leader downloads